

Three Ring Circus

“A few clowns short of a circus.”

“Ladies and gentlemen, children of all ages, step right up and you will be amazed. Right before your very eyes, we will try to make your money disappear.” That may be the favorite line of circus ringmasters and the credit card industry, but we’re on to the tricks of the trade. Their dog and pony show is being told to take down their tents and hit the road.

(No offense intended to the trapeze artists and acrobats and all the great talents of the circus. Personally, I enjoy the lion tamers.)

Yingling and Friends’ Circus

In the documentary *Secret History of Credit Cards*, the president of the American Bankers Association, Edward Yingling, was interviewed. He is the guy that hangs out with the politicians and fights for the banking and credit card industry to be able to keep on doing what they are doing. That’s right – appalling interest rates, exorbitant fees, and a penalty mentality. An excerpt of the interview follows:

INTERVIEWER: Have you ever read the contract that’s sent to you with your credit card?

EDWARD YINGLING: Yes. But I’m a lawyer. *[laughs]*